Document Control

Title **Spinal patient pathway Standard Operating Procedure**			
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1. Background

1.1. Patients who have spinal cord/column/diseased conditions need to be cared for by specially trained staff to ensure an optimum outcome or recovery is achieved. Unless cared for correctly following a specific care plan devised by an Orthopaedic / neurology team possibly from a referring Surgical Spinal Specialist Centre (SSSC), Spinal Specialist Centre (SSC), Major Trauma Centre (MTC the patient has an increased risk of incurring adverse effects. The Northern Devon Healthcare Trust is working collaboratively with the Peninsula Trauma Network Group and patients who present to the Trust with no or limited documented care planning need to be cared for appropriately.

2. Purpose

2.1 The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) has been written to:

- Ensure patients with spinal cord/column/disease conditions admitted to Northern Devon Healthcare Trust via the Emergency department, via a Surgical Spinal Specialist Centre (SSSC), Spinal Specialist Centre (SSC), Major Trauma Centre (MTC) or other referring area are cared for in Capener ward.
- If co-morbidities/conditions require other specialised care until the patient is stable enough to be nursed in Capener ward, then the Orthopaedic Surgeons will work in collaboration with other medical teams to determine which department the patient will be admitted to, if Capener ward is deemed to be unsuitable for the patients' needs.
- If the patient is to be nursed in an area other than Capener ward, staff from Capener ward trained and competent in this field of care will be available to assist/advise when required.
- Orthopaedic medical staff will assess and document the patients need for spinal cord, column and disease care including cervical collar choice, turning/ mobility regime, bladder and bowel care and make an informed decision as to whether a referral to another department is necessary.
- Clinical Site Managers or Site Managers will ensure that the staff establishment on Capener ward will be back filled to allow staff to advise/assist other wards, where possible
- Ensure the patient is cared for appropriately and safely by suitable trained staff to deal with spinal cord/spinal column or spinal diseased conditions wherever they are accommodated .
- Discharge arrangements will be made closely with the community nurse and therapy teams to provide on going care

3. Scope

- This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) relates to the following staff groups who may be involved in the assessment and delivery of spinal cord/spinal column or spinal diseased conditions.

- Registered Nurses
- Physiotherapists
- Occupational Therapists
- Support Workers
- Medical Staff

4. Location

4.1. This Standard Operating Procedure for spinal care placement can be implemented in all clinical areas where competent staff are available or can access help from Capener staff to undertake this role.

4.2. Staff undertaking this procedure must be able to demonstrate continued competence as per the organisations policy on assessing and maintaining competence.

5. Procedure

- Algorithm Appendix A will be followed for patients who have spinal injury conditions
- Algorithm Appendix B will be followed for patients who have spinal column injury conditions
- Algorithm Appendix C will be followed for patients who have spinal disease conditions.

6. References

- Peninsula Trauma Network Guidelines.